

Word family: **ideal / ideals / ideally / idealise / idealize / idealised / idealized / idealisation / idealization / idealism / idealist / idealistic**

Base word: ideal

Plural noun: ideals

Related forms: ideally, idealise/idealize, idealisation/idealization, idealism, idealist, idealistic

Part of speech: adjective (形容詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “At the same time, the learning environment itself is far from **ideal**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **ideal** means **as good, suitable, or favourable as possible for a particular purpose**.

The writer means that a noisy restaurant with people talking, trays clattering, and frequent interruptions is **not a very suitable environment for serious study**.

繁體中文： **理想的；最適合的；在某種情況下最有利、最合適的**

中文翻譯：

> “...the learning environment itself is far from **ideal**.”

「.....與此同時，這種學習環境本身也**遠非理想**。」

Here:

far from ideal = 與最合適 / 最有利的情況相差很遠；很不理想

1. **ideal = perfectly or highly suitable for a particular purpose (合適) — 理想的；最適合的**

This is the **exact passage sense**.

Practice 1 — Original

> “A noisy restaurant is far from **ideal** for serious study.”

「嘈雜的餐廳對認真學習而言**很不理想**。」

Practice 2

> “This room is **ideal** for small meetings.”

「這個房間非常**適合**舉行小型會議。」

Practice 3

> “The mild weather is **ideal** for hiking.”

「溫和的天氣非常**適合**遠足。」

****ideal for something = 對某個用途而言非常合適，幾乎是最佳條件****

Common:

- * ideal for studying
- * ideal location
- * ideal candidate
- * ideal solution
- * ideal conditions
- * ideal environment

2. ****ideal = as good or perfect as one could reasonably want (完美狀態) — 理想的；近乎完美的****

Sometimes ****ideal**** emphasizes perfection rather than merely suitability.

Practice 4

> “Under ****ideal**** conditions, the experiment should work perfectly.”

「在****理想條件****下，這項實驗應該可以完美運作。」

Practice 5

> “It was not an ****ideal**** situation, but we managed.”

「那並不是一個****理想的情況****，但我們還是應付過去了。」

****ideal = 非常接近心目中最好、最完美的狀態****

For strict counting, this and Meaning 1 belong to the same broad adjective branch:

> ****best / most suitable / most favourable****

3. **ideal** = imagined perfect situation that may not exist in reality (理想化) — 理想中的 ; 完美但未必現實的

Ideal can contrast with what actually happens in the real world.

Practice 6

> “In an **ideal** world, everyone would have enough time to rest.”

「在**理想世界**裡，每個人都會有足夠時間休息。」

Practice 7

> “The plan works well in the **ideal** case, but reality is more complicated.”

「這個計劃在**理想情況**下運作良好，但現實更加複雜。」

Here, **ideal** means:

> **a perfect theoretical situation used as a standard, even though real conditions may differ**

This is an important extension.

4. **ideal** = theoretical/simplified perfect model (科學 / 學術) — 理想化的 ; 理論上的

In science, economics, mathematics, engineering, etc., **ideal** often describes a deliberately simplified theoretical model that behaves according to perfect assumptions.

Examples:

- * ideal gas
- * ideal solution
- * ideal fluid
- * ideal system
- * ideal conditions

Practice 8

> “An **ideal gas** is a simplified theoretical model.”

「**理想氣體**是一種簡化的理論模型。」

Practice 9

> “The calculation assumes **ideal** conditions.”

「這項計算假設處於**理想化條件**。」

ideal = 為了理論分析而假設完全符合某些完美條件的，不一定真實存在

This is established enough to surface separately, even though it develops from the “perfect” sense.

5. **an ideal** = a perfect model or standard to aim for (名詞) — 理想典範；完美標準

As a noun, **ideal** can mean a conception or example of perfection.

Practice 10

> “She regarded the school as an **ideal** of educational excellence.”

「她把這間學校視為卓越教育的**理想典範**。」

Practice 11

> “The design comes close to the **ideal**.”

「這個設計已經非常接近**理想標準**。」

an ideal = 人們認為最完美、最值得追求的標準或典範

This is a major noun sense.

6. **ideal** = principle, value, or goal that one strongly believes in (理想 / 理念) — 理想；崇高理念；信念

Plural **ideals** is particularly common here.

Practice 12

> “She remained committed to her **ideals**.”

「她一直堅守自己的**理想 / 信念**。」

Practice 13

> “The organisation was founded on the **ideals** of fairness and cooperation.”

「這個機構建基於公平和合作的**理念**。」

ideals = 人認為值得追求、遵守或實現的重要原則和價值

Common:

- * democratic ideals
- * educational ideals
- * moral ideals
- * social ideals
- * high ideals

This is genuinely different from:

> ideal = suitable/perfect

because here the noun refers to an **aspiration or principle**.

7. **ideal** = person regarded as the perfect example of a type (理想典型) — 理想人選；完美典型

A person or thing may be described as someone's **ideal**.

Practice 14

> “He did not fit her **ideal** of a leader.”

「他並不符合她心目中領袖的**理想典型**。」

Practice 15

> “The candidate closely matches the company's **ideal**.”

「這位候選人很接近公司心目中的**理想人選標準**。」

For strict counting, this belongs with Meaning 5: **perfect model/standard**.

8. **ideal** = abstract form/concept contrasted with reality (哲學) — 理念的；觀念上的

In philosophy and highly formal writing, **ideal** can relate to ideas, mental conceptions, or

abstract perfect forms rather than concrete material reality.

Examples include discussions of:

- * ideal forms
- * ideal entities
- * ideal reality

The exact meaning depends strongly on the philosophical framework.

****繁體中文： ** **理念上的；觀念上的；理想形式的****

****Database status:** genuine specialist/philosophical use, but not ordinary learner core.**

9. ****ideal** = mathematical structure in ring theory (數學) — 理想******

In abstract algebra, an ****ideal**** is a special subset of a ring satisfying particular closure properties.

Example:

> “This set forms an ****ideal**** in the ring.”

「這個集合構成該環中的一個****理想****。」

This is a completely specialized mathematical noun.

It should be retained in a comprehensive audit but clearly separated from ordinary English meanings.

Related form: ****ideally****

****Ideally**** has two very useful meanings.

1. **ideally = under the best possible circumstances (理想情況下) — 理想地；在最理想情況下******

Practice 16

> “Ideally, students should have a quiet place to study.”

「****理想情況下****，學生應該有一個安靜的地方學習。」

This often introduces what would be best, even if reality does not match it.

2. **ideally suited = extremely well suited (非常適合) **

Practice 17

> “The room is **ideally suited** to small-group teaching.”

「這個房間**非常適合**小組教學。」

Here:

ideally = in the most suitable possible way

Related verb: **idealise / idealize**

Idealise/idealize means to represent or imagine someone/something as better, more perfect, or more admirable than reality justifies.

Practice 18

> “People sometimes **idealise** the past.”

「人們有時會把過去**理想化 / 美化**。」

Practice 19

> “The film **idealizes** village life.”

「這部電影把鄉村生活**理想化**了。」

idealise = 忽略缺點，把某人 / 某事想像或描繪得過分完美

This is an important family verb.

Related form: **idealisation / idealization**

This means the process or result of idealising something.

Practice 20

> “The novel avoids the **idealisation** of poverty.”

「這本小說避免把貧困**理想化 / 美化**。」

Useful in:

- * literary analysis
- * psychology
- * sociology
- * everyday critical writing

Related form: **idealism**

Idealism has two major meanings of its own.

1. **belief in high principles / desire to make things better (理想主義)**

Practice 21

> “Her youthful **idealism** motivated her to work for social causes.”

「她年輕時的**理想主義**推動她投入公益工作。」

Here:

idealism = 相信崇高理想並努力按照那些理想行事的態度

2. **philosophical idealism (哲學) — 唯心主義 / 觀念論**

In philosophy, **idealism** refers to families of theories giving a fundamental role to mind, ideas, consciousness, or mental structures in accounts of reality or knowledge.

This is a specialist philosophical sense and should not be confused with ordinary:

> “He’s an idealist.”

= 他是個理想主義者。

Related form: **idealist**

An **idealist** is usually someone guided strongly by ideals and high principles, sometimes without enough attention to practical limitations.

Practice 22

> “He is an **idealist** who believes society can be greatly improved.”

「他是一位相信社會可以大幅改善的**理想主義者**。」

Depending on tone, this can be:

- * admiring;
- * neutral;
- * mildly critical.

Related form: **idealistic**

Idealistic means guided by ideals, often with optimistic expectations about how things should be.

Practice 23

> “The proposal is admirable but perhaps too **idealistic**.”

「這項建議值得欣賞，但可能有點過於**理想化 / 理想主義**。」

idealistic = 以理想和高尚原則為導向，但有時可能不夠實際

Important distinction: **ideal vs perfect**

perfect

means having no faults or completely meeting the standard.

ideal

often means **best suited for a particular purpose**, even if it is not literally flawless.

> “This room is ideal for studying.”

does not mean:

> “This room is absolutely perfect in every respect.”

It means:

> **very well suited to studying**

This distinction is particularly relevant to your passage.

Important distinction: **ideal vs suitable**

suitable

= acceptable/right for a purpose.

ideal

= exceptionally or optimally suitable.

Compare:

> suitable location

> ideal location

Ideal is stronger.

Important distinction: **ideal vs appropriate**

appropriate

means fitting or proper for the circumstances.

ideal

means the best or most favourable option.

Something can be appropriate without being ideal.

Important distinction: **ideal vs desirable**

desirable

means wanted or beneficial.

ideal

means closest to the best possible condition.

> desirable outcome

> ideal outcome

The second is stronger.

Important distinction: **ideal vs realistic**

These can contrast:

ideal

= what would be best.

realistic

= what can reasonably happen under actual conditions.

Example:

> "The ideal solution is free study space for everyone, but we need a realistic short-term plan."

The ideal may be worth aiming for even if it is not immediately realistic.

Important distinction: **ideal vs imaginary**

imaginary

means existing only in imagination.

ideal

can describe something hypothetical, but usually because it represents a **perfect or optimal standard**.

- > imaginary city
- > ideal city

Different concepts.

Important distinction: **ideal vs utopian**

utopian

suggests an imagined perfect system, often unrealistically perfect.

ideal

is much broader and does not necessarily imply impossibility.

- > ideal working conditions

can be perfectly realistic.

- > utopian society

often suggests a much more sweeping vision of perfection.

Important distinction: **ideal vs idealistic**

ideal

usually describes:

- * best condition;
- * best choice;
- * standard of perfection.

idealistic

describes a person, plan, or outlook strongly guided by ideals.

- > ideal study environment
- > idealistic young teacher

Not interchangeable.

Important distinction: **ideal vs idealised**

ideal

can genuinely be the best option:

> an ideal location

idealised

means represented as more perfect than reality:

> an idealised picture of city life

So **idealised** often implies distortion or simplification.

Grammar note: **ideal for + noun/-ing**

Very common:

> ideal for students

> ideal for studying

> ideal for small businesses

= **非常適合.....**

Grammar note: **ideal to + verb**

Possible:

> "This tool is ideal to use in small spaces."

But in many contexts, more natural English is:

> "This tool is ideal **for use** in small spaces."

or:

> "This tool is ideal **for using** in small spaces."

Grammar note: ****the ideal + noun****

> the ideal candidate

> the ideal solution

> the ideal location

= ****最理想的.....****

Grammar note: ****far from ideal****

A very common fixed construction:

> far from ideal

= ****很不理想 / 與理想狀態相差甚遠****

Practice 24

> “The conditions were far from ****ideal****.”

「那些條件****很不理想****。」

This is exactly your passage construction.

Grammar note: ****ideally, ...****

At the beginning of a sentence:

> “Ideally, we would have more space.”

means:

> ****如果條件最理想的話 / 最理想的做法是.....****

It often contrasts with practical reality.

Countability note

ideal — principle/standard

Countable:

- > an ideal
- > several ideals

Examples:

- > high ideals
- > political ideals
- > an ideal of beauty

ideal — adjective

No countability issue:

- > ideal conditions
- > ideal candidate

idealism

Usually uncountable:

- > youthful idealism
- > philosophical idealism

idealist

Countable:

- > an idealist
- > several idealists

Family-extension note

The practical family includes:

- * **ideal**
- * **ideals**
- * **ideally**
- * **idealise / idealize**
- * **idealised / idealized**
- * **idealisation / idealization**

* **idealism**
 * **idealist**
 * **idealistic**
 * **idealistically**

Lower-priority:

* **ideality** — state/quality of being ideal; uncommon outside specialist writing.

Useful constructions include:

* ideal for
 * ideal candidate
 * ideal conditions
 * ideal solution
 * ideal world
 * far from ideal
 * ideally suited
 * high ideals
 * idealise the past

A proper second-pass sweep also reveals:

* **ideal gas / ideal solution / ideal model** — scientific/theoretical
 * **ideal** in abstract algebra — mathematical technical noun
 * **idealism** — both everyday ideals-based outlook and philosophical doctrine

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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ideal — suitable/best	對特定目的而言極為合適、最有利或近乎最佳的
ideal — perfect condition	接近心目中最好 / 最完美的狀態
ideal — hypothetical/theoretical	假設符合完美條件、用作理論模型或比較標準的
an ideal — model/standard	被視為完美並值得追求的標準 / 典範
ideals — principles	人認為值得追求、遵守或實現的重要價值、信念或目標
ideal — philosophy	與理念 / 抽象觀念而非具體物質現實有關；專門
ideal — mathematics	抽象代數環論中的「理想」；高度專門
ideally	在最理想情況下；或以最合適的方式
idealise / idealize	把某人 / 某事想像或描繪得比實際更完美
idealisation	理想化 / 美化的過程或結果
idealism — ordinary	以崇高理想和原則為導向的理想主義
idealism — philosophy	唯心主義 / 觀念論等哲學理論
idealist	強烈相信並追求理想的人；理想主義者
idealistic	以理想為導向的；有時暗示不夠實際

For your original sentence

> "...the learning environment itself is far from **ideal**."

The exact meaning is:

ideal = 最適合學生專心學習、集中精神並有效完成學習活動的狀態

So:

> **far from ideal**

= 遠非理想 / 很不適合

The writer is not saying that a learning environment must be literally **perfect**. Rather, the restaurant is **far less suitable** than the conditions students would reasonably need for serious concentration.

For your database, I would count **4 genuinely useful core meanings** for **ideal**:

1. **adjective: exceptionally suitable / best for a particular purpose**
2. **adjective: perfect or theoretical model/condition, sometimes contrasting with reality**
3. **noun: perfect standard/model to aim for**
4. **noun plural `ideals`: principles, values, or aspirations one believes should be pursued**

I would keep scientific **ideal gas/model/solution** under #2, surface philosophical **ideal** as a lower-priority domain use, and preserve mathematical **ideal** as a genuine but highly specialist separate noun. **Idealise, idealism, idealist, idealistic** deserve explicit family coverage because their modern meanings are common and no longer completely predictable from the adjective alone.